26900096 **Reg.No : .....**

Name : .....

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (Honours)/ MGU-BBA (Honours)/ MGU-BCA (Honours)

REGULAR EXAMINATION OCTOBER 2026

FIFTH SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG5DSEBBA301 - CONSUMER BEHAVIOUR

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability. Each question carries 3 Marks

Part A

Short Answer Questions(four to five sentences)

A choice between two options for each question- answer five short answer questions, one from each pair, Each question carries 3 Marks

1a. Describe the concept of Value Perception. [U] / [CO1]

OR

1b.. State the relationship between Consumer Behaviour and marketing concepts. [U] / [CO1]

2a. Explain the major stages involved in the consumer decision-making process. [K] / [CO2]

OR

2b. What is a consumer decision-making model? Briefly explain the Economic Model of consumer behaviour. [K] / [CO2]

3a. Explain any three factors that determine the influence of a reference group on consumer behaviour. [K] / [CO3]

OR

3b. Explain how subculture affects the buying decisions of Indian consumers. [An] / [CO3]

4a. A customer compares prices, reads online reviews and purchases through a mobile app. Identify and explain how digital transformation has influenced this [A] / [CO1]

consumer's buying behaviour.

OR

4b. What is meant by Customer Experience? [K] / [CO1]

5a. List any three personal antecedents of consumer involvement. [K] / [CO4]

OR

5b. What is personality? How can consumption choices contribute to self-expression? [A] / [CO4]

[5x3 = 15]

Part B

Short Essay

A choice between two options for each question- answer three short essay questions, one from each pair, Each question carries 5 Marks.

6a. Explain the major objectives of the Consumer Protection Act, 2019. [U] / [CO1]

OR

6b. A food company notices that consumers are increasingly preferring healthier products. Explain how the company can use Consumer Behaviour knowledge to respond to this change. [A] / [CO1]

7a. Discuss how focus group discussions and in-depth interviews help in understanding consumer motivations. [U] / [CO2]

OR

7b. Explain, with an example, how consumer profiles help in designing promotional campaigns. [U] / [CO2]

8a. Explain the organisational buying process in detail, highlighting the major stages from identification of need to evaluation of supplier performance. [K] / [CO2]

OR

8b. A young professional purchases an expensive branded handbag because she believes it will improve her social image and make her feel more confident. Identify the relevant buying motives and explain how they influence her purchase decision. [A] / [CO2]

[3x5 = 15]

Part C

Long Essay

A choice between two options for each question- answer two long essay questions, one from each pair, Each question carries 20 Marks

9a. What are the stages of the Family Life Cycle. Explain the importance of family and households in consumer buying behaviour. [U] / [CO3]

OR

9b. Analyse how the relative importance of internal and external influences varies across different purchase situations. Discuss the influence of personal factors, psychological factors, family, reference groups, culture, social class and marketing stimuli on high-involvement and low-involvement purchase decisions, with suitable examples. [An] / [CO3]

[1x20 = 20]

Part D

Compulsory Case study analysis (10a), Question carries 20 Marks

10a. The Case: "ZapCola's Jingle Problem" ZapCola, a regional soft-drink brand, launched an aggressive TV and radio campaign in 2021 featuring a catchy five-second jingle — "Zap it, Sip it, Love it!" — played at the end of every advertisement. Within three months, unprompted recall studies showed that 68% of respondents could hum the jingle, and sales during the campaign period rose by 22%. However, once the campaign was paused for six months (due to a budget cut), recall dropped to just 11%, and repeat-purchase data showed that most of the sales spike had been driven by one-time trial purchases rather than habitual buyers. Exit interviews revealed that many consumers who had tried ZapCola once did not associate the brand with any particular usage occasion (e.g., "drink with pizza" or "post-workout refresher") and simply forgot to repurchase it. In contrast, ZapCola's competitor, FizzUp, had run a much smaller-budget campaign that consistently linked its drink to the specific ritual of "Sunday family lunches," using repeated storytelling ads over two years rather than a single catchy jingle. FizzUp's recall figures were lower immediately after each ad burst, but its repeat-purchase rate was significantly higher and more stable over time. ZapCola's marketing head is now debating whether to relaunch the same jingle campaign or to invest in building deeper associations similar to FizzUp's approach. [An] / [CO4]

Questions:

i). Define consumer learning and explain, with reference to the case, how ZapCola's campaign reflects principles of classical or operant conditioning.

ii). Distinguish between short-term memory (STM) and long-term memory (LTM). In your opinion, why did the jingle create strong STM recall but weak LTM retention.

iii). Suggest two marketing strategies ZapCola could use to stimulate short-term memory and two strategies to build long-term learning.

[1x20 = 20]